

Backups

Backups of all production databases run nightly at 02:00. Backups are kept for ninety days and stored in a second data centre. A restore test is carried out on the first Monday of every month.

Password policy

Passwords must have at least fourteen characters. Multi-factor authentication is mandatory for all accounts with access to production systems. Passwords are changed only after a suspected compromise, not on a fixed schedule.

Incident response

Security incidents are reported to the on-call engineer within thirty minutes of discovery. The on-call engineer opens an incident ticket and assigns a severity from one to four. Severity one incidents require a written report within two working days.

Patching

Operating system patches are installed during the maintenance window on the second Tuesday of each month between 22:00 and 24:00. Critical security patches may be installed outside the window after approval by the head of IT.

Access requests

Access to systems is requested through the service desk and approved by the line manager. Approved requests are processed within two working days. Access rights are reviewed every six months and unused accounts are disabled after ninety days of inactivity.

Monitoring alerts

The monitoring system sends an alert when disk usage exceeds eighty-five percent or when response time stays above two seconds for five minutes. Alerts go to the on-call engineer by phone call. If the alert is not acknowledged within ten minutes, it is escalated to the team lead.